

BANDEEP SINGH

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ARJUN SETH, *38*

Automobile manufacturer, ***Delhi***

Dream fulfilled: **Lost 13 kilos**

How Covid changed me

"It gave me the motivation to make a permanent lifestyle change and aim towards long-term, holistic well-being"

yourself from the daily pressures, it rejuvenates you mentally, physically and spiritually."

For Yash Aggarwal, the 24-year-old co-founder of Delhi restaurant Bougie, it was a push from his father, who fell seriously ill during Covid's second wave, that persuaded him to take a leap of faith. He finally overcame his fear of heights and went skydiving in Dubai this March. Jumping off a plane 13,000 feet above the ground changed his life, he says. "The free fall, which lasted 22 seconds, was completely surreal. And I realised that one should not spend one's life wasting away chances, just do what one wants to do when the chance comes."

These pursuits are not temporary. Everyone talks of a new approach to life being instilled in them, and a sense that this change will endure. Seeing family and friends "gasp for oxygen, struggle to get medicines, and drop like ninepins" was a life-altering thing for Delhi-based Dipinder Singh. "The pandemic changed my perception about a lot of things. I realised I needed to care for myself," says the fashion designer. Always an avid runner, Singh now spends at least three hours every day swimming, running, cycling or working out in a gym. "I don't feel the need now to hang on to people. I focus on myself. If I don't do it, who will?" he asks.

New Job, New You

If a lot of people are finding emotional sustenance outside of the workplace, others are looking for it at work itself. This could mean changing one's profession entirely—or at least finding employment that makes one feel more contented. Randstad NV, a global provider of